

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: A friend in need is a friend indeed.



Learning Outcome

Describe hypothetical situations in written and spoken interactions according to work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- When was the last time that you helped someone in need? What did you do?
- How did the person show their appreciation?

Can Do Statements

- I can write about friendship, relationships, feelings and reactions.
- I can write stories and anecdotes and talk about experiences I've had or haven't had.
- I can write about things that happened or were happening.





Let's Explore!

Vanessa receives a **frantic*** phone call. Is she able to help her friend in need?

* "Frantic" means feeling or showing a lot of fear and worry.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Yesterday afternoon, I received a frantic telephone call from my best friend, Rebecca, who had worked the graveyard shift for the last three months. She sounded very annoyed and in desperate need of some peace and quiet. She was suffering from a terrible headache and was frustrated that she had to deal with inconsiderate neighbors. It was so noisy around there that she had even bought earplugs and taken a sleeping tablet.

The baby next door had been crying for hours and she couldn't fathom why the child's parents hadn't done anything about it. The little boy across the hall had practiced his electric guitar every day this week despite complaints from other tenants. The neighbors across the hall were arguing as usual. They had been arguing since the day they moved in. Just to make things worse, the man upstairs was pacing nonstop and moving the furniture. She said she had to get out of here and was coming right over. I was delighted to have Rebecca as a visitor, and rushed out to buy something at the bakery.

However, I wished she hadn't hung up so quickly. She didn't give me time to tell her that the road in front of my house has been under repair for weeks! There were maintenance crews everywhere, and the asphalt was being relaid. She wasn't going to get any sleep at my house either. She ended up falling asleep in front of the television. Poor girl!





Let's Practice!

Alice talks about what was happening with her friend.

Instructions: Write the missing information. Use the correct option below each sentence. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. She _____ from a horrible headache due to the lack of sleep and the noise from her neighbors.
(**was suffering / were suffering / had suffering**)
2. My friend _____ that she had to deal with inconsiderable neighbors.
(**was frustrating / felt so frustrated / felt frustrated so**)
3. The neighbors across the floor _____ as usual.
(**were arguing / had argue / argues**)
4. Just to make things worst, the man upstairs _____ nonstop and moving furniture.
(**paced / had paced / was pacing**)
5. When she called me she _____ she had to leave her apartment immediately get some sleep at my house.
(**said / told / was saying**)

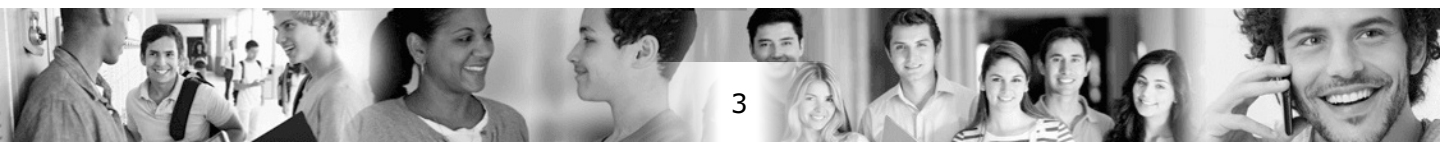


Let's Practice!

Think of a time when you helped a friend in need. What happened?

*Instructions: *Write a 120-150 word diary entry about a time when you helped a friend or partner. *Explain your relationship. Is he/she your best friend? Are you talking about your husband or wife? *Describe the situation. Why was your friend or partner in need of help? Answer the questions who, what, when, where and why. *What was your reaction to their call for help? *How did you assist them? *Use the Past Continuous tense and the Simple Past tense. *Write your essay on an extra piece of paper.*

Dear Diary,





Extension Activity

Everyone needs a friend.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write a 120-150 word diary entry about a time when a friend helped you in a difficult situation. What happened?
- Describe the situation. Answer the questions who, what, when, where and why.
- What was your reaction? How did you feel?
- How did they assist you?
- What happened in the end?
- Use the Past Continuous tense and the Simple Past tense.
- When completed, read the diary entry aloud to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I write a diary entry about a personal experience.

☐ ☐

I describe my reactions in certain events.

☐ ☐

I write about the past using a range of verb tenses in a diary entry.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to fathom** (verb): to understand
e.g. She couldn't fathom why the child's parents hadn't done anything about it.
- graveyard shift** (noun): a work shift which is during late night and early morning hours
e.g. Rebecca has worked the graveyard shift for the last three months.
- inconsiderate** (adjective): not caring about other people's feelings
e.g. She was frustrated that she had to deal with inconsiderate neighbors.
- electric guitar** (noun): a guitar whose tone is magnified electrically by a microphone or pick-up device
e.g. The little boy across the hall had practiced his electric guitar every day this week.
- asphalt** (noun): a black substance that forms a hard surface when it dries; it is commonly used as a surface for roads
e.g. The asphalt was being relaid.
- to pace** (verb): to walk in one direction and then in the opposite direction, repeatedly
e.g. The man upstairs was pacing nonstop and moving the furniture.
- tenant** (noun): a person who rents a room, building, or piece of land
e.g. Despite complaints from other tenants, the boy played his electric guitar all the week.





Learning Points

Present Perfect tense vs. Past Simple tense

You use the Present Perfect tense to talk about a finished action or event that is connected to the present in some way.

You use the Simple Past tense to talk about a finished action or event **not** necessarily connected to the present.

You can use the Present Perfect tense to talk about experience.

When you use the Present Perfect tense, you think about the past and present together. There is some connection between what happened in the past and now.

To help you decide whether you should use the Present Perfect tense or the Past Simple tense, ask yourself the question 'When?'

If you can answer the question 'When?', the past time is stated or inferred or understood. Use the Past Simple. There is no connection to the present.

If you cannot answer the question 'When?', because the time is not stated or not important, then choose the Present Perfect tense. There is instead a connection to the present.

Sentence	When?
<i>When she called, she told me about her situation.</i>	when she called
<i>She's just arrived at my house.</i>	recently (from the time she left)

Examples:

- *Yesterday afternoon, I received a frantic telephone call from my best friend.*
- *The road in front of my house has been under repair for weeks!*
- *She has worked the graveyard shift at the hospital for the last three months.*





Learning Points

Past Continuous tense v.s Past Simple tense

You use the Past Continuous tense to talk about an action that was happening at a time before now.

You use the Simple Past to talk about a finished past action.

You can use the Past Continuous to:

- to describe the background in a story written in the past tense

For example:

*My friend **was watching** television.*

- to describe an action that was interrupted by another event or action

For example:

*While **she was** watching television there was a knock at the door.*

The form of the Past Continuous is:

Subject + *was/were* + verb-*ing*

You use the Simple Past to talk about a shorter action or event that happened in the middle of, or interrupted, the longer action.

*They were taking turns, swapping stories , and helping each other when her husband **arrived**.*

Examples:

- *She was suffering from a terrible headache and was frustrated that she had to deal with inconsiderate neighbors.*
- *I received a frantic telephone call from my best friend, Rebecca.*
- *The man upstairs was pacing nonstop and moving the furniture.*

